QUICK-START & STEP-BY-STEP MANUAL (V1.1.0)

Flow Music MCP — Simple Step-by-Step Guide

Turn any MP3 song into a consistent, scene-by-scene AI Music Video using Claude Code + Google Gemini + Google Flow Music

PART A — ONE-TIME SETUP (DO THIS ONLY ONCE ON YOUR COMPUTER)

Run these 3 steps in a regular **PowerShell / Terminal** window (*before* opening Claude):

ONCE 1 Install & Build the MCP Engine

Run in PowerShell

```
cd "C:\Users\Maddy\Documents\Python\Data_Projects\flow-music-mcp"
npm install
npm run build
```

ONCE 2 Connect the MCP Server to Claude Code Globally

Run in PowerShell (outside Claude)

```
claude mcp add --scope user flow-music -- node "C:\Users\Maddy\Documents\Python\Data_Projects\flow-music-mcp\dist\index.j
s"
```

Using `--scope user` registers `flow-music` across your entire computer so it works in any song folder.

ONCE 3 Sign In to Google Flow Music & Save Your Gemini Key

Run in PowerShell / Claude

```
npm run login
```

A dedicated Chrome window opens at **https://www.flowmusic.app/**. Click **Login** → **Continue with Google**. Leave Chrome open! Your Gemini API key is saved at `~/.flow-music-mcp/gemini-key` (or tell Claude: "*Set my Gemini key to ...*").

PART B — EVERYDAY CHECKLIST: MAKING A MUSIC VIDEO FOR ANY NEW SONG

Every time you have a new song MP3, follow these **6 simple steps** in order:

STEP 1 Put Your Song MP3 in Its Own Folder & Start Claude

PowerShell

Create a folder for your song (e.g., `C:\Users\Maddy\Music\MyNewSong`), drop your `.mp3` inside it, and start Claude:

```
claude
```

Tip: Make sure your Google Flow Music Chrome window from `npm run login` is open in the background.

STEP 2 Connect Your Song Folder & Extract Lyrics + Timestamps

Type inside Claude

> "*Connect to my song folder at C:\Users\Maddy\Music\MyNewSong and identify the lyrics and MM:SS timestamps from the MP3.*"

Claude connects to your MP3, uploads the audio to Gemini, and extracts every vocal line and instrumental break with exact `MM:SS` timestamps.

STEP 3 Create Your Visual Style, Characters & Sub-10-Second Storyboard

Type inside Claude

> "*Set the visual style and main character, then create a storyboard of sub-10-second scenes for the whole song.*"

Claude creates `STORYBOARD.md` and `storyboard.json` inside your song folder, labeling each scene as either `generate_start_frame` (new camera angle/scene) or `use_previous_last_frame` (continuous motion from the previous shot).

STEP 4 Review & Tweak Any Scene (In Chat or in STORYBOARD.md)

Type inside Claude or Edit File

> "*Change Scene 3 to a close-up tracking shot in the rain, and set Scene 4 to use_previous_last_frame.*"

Or open `STORYBOARD.md` in any text editor, edit the table directly, save, and tell Claude: "*Sync my storyboard from markdown.*"

STEP 5 Generate Character Sheets & Starting Scene Images

Type inside Claude

> "*Generate the character reference sheets and all scene start frames.*"

Saves character sheets to `characters/` and scene start frames to `scenes/scene-01-start.png`. (Automatically uses Gemini 2026 image models or falls back to your signed-in `flowmusic.app` browser session if your AI Studio key is on the Free Tier.)

STEP 6 Open Google Flow Music & Generate All Scene Videos

Type inside Claude

> "*Open a new Google Flow Music session with my MP3, initiate the storyboard, and generate all scene videos.*"

Claude drives your signed-in `flowmusic.app` Chrome window, attaches your MP3 and each scene's start frame (or extracts the previous video's last frame), generates every video clip, and downloads `videos/scene-01.mp4`, `scene-02.mp4`, etc. into your song folder!

1. UNDERSTANDING THE TWO FOLDERS (ENGINE VS. SONG FOLDER)

Folder A: The MCP Engine Folder (Set Up Once)

Path: `C:\Users\Maddy\Documents\Python\Data_Projects\flow-music-mcp`

Holds the TypeScript MCP server code. You only run `npm run build` or `npm run login` here. **Do not put your song MP3s here.**

Folder B: Your Song MP3 Folder (One Per Song)

Example Path: `C:\Users\Maddy\Music\MySong`

Put your `.mp3` here. All generated files (`STORYBOARD.md`, `characters/`, `scenes/`, `videos/`) are saved right inside this folder.

```
<your-song-mp3-folder>/
├── song.mp3                # Your input MP3 audio track
├── STORYBOARD.md           # Human-editable Markdown table (Lyrics, Style Bible, Characters, Scenes)
├── storyboard.json         # Machine-readable storyboard state (two-way synced with STORYBOARD.md)
├── characters/             # Character reference sheets (e.g., char_lead.png)
├── scenes/                 # Starting keyframe images (scene-01-start.png, scene-03-last.png, ...)
└── videos/                 # Final MP4 video clips from Google Flow Music (scene-01.mp4, scene-02.mp4, ...)
```

2. HOW SCENE CONTINUITY WORKS (START FRAME VS. PREVIOUS LAST FRAME)

Mode 1: `generate_start_frame`

Generates a brand-new starting keyframe image (`scenes/scene-NN-start.png`) using your locked Character Model Sheet and Style Anchor. Best when cutting to a new location, new camera angle, or the first shot of the video.

Mode 2: `use_previous_last_frame`

Automatically extracts the **exact final video frame** from Scene *N-1* (`scenes/scene-NN-last.png`) and uploads it as the starting frame of Scene *N* in Google Flow Music so the motion continues seamlessly.

3. ZERO-RESTART CONFIGURATION & V1.1.0 TROUBLESHOOTING FAQ

FAQ 1 **Where are my API Key and Settings stored? Do I ever need to restart Claude?**

- **Gemini API Key:** Saved in `C:\Users\Maddy\.flow-music-mcp\gemini-key` (supports both `AIzaSy...` and `AQ....` keys).
- **Runtime Config:** Optional overrides in `C:\Users\Maddy\.flow-music-mcp\config.json` (e.g., `{"imageModel": "gemini-3.1-flash-image"}`).
- **Chrome Profile:** Saved in `C:\Users\Maddy\.flow-music-mcp\chrome-profile` (runs on CDP port `9334`).
- **No Restart Needed:** Every tool reads your key and config fresh on each call—you never need to edit environment variables or restart Claude.

FAQ 2 **Why did Google AI Studio say "Quota Exceeded (limit: 0)" for Image Generation?**

- Google AI Studio allows **free audio analysis** (Phase 1 lyrics & timestamps) on the unbilled Free Tier, but sets `limit: 0` on all `*-image` models (`gemini-3.1-flash-image`, `gemini-nano-banana-2.1`, `gemini-2.5-flash-image`) unless a billing account is linked in Google AI Studio.
- **Built-in Automatic Fallback (v1.1.0):** When `flow-music-mcp` detects a Free-Tier `limit: 0` response from the Gemini API, it **automatically falls back to your signed-in `flowmusic.app` Chrome window** to generate the image using your Google Flow Music account!
- Alternatively, if you enable Pay-as-you-go billing on your Google AI Studio project, direct Gemini API image generation unlocks immediately.

FAQ 3 **What if Chrome is closed when I reach Phase 5?**

- Just tell Claude: "*Run login_flow_music to open the Chrome window.*" (Or run `npm run login` in PowerShell). Because your Google login is saved in `~/.flow-music-mcp/chrome-profile`, you stay signed into `flowmusic.app` automatically.

Quick Recovery Tip: If you close Claude Code and come back tomorrow to finish an existing song, just open Claude and say:
"Check status and load my storyboard at C:\Users\Maddy\Music\MySong." Claude will pick up right where you left off!

4. COMPLETE V1.1.0 MCP TOOLS, RESOURCES & PROMPTS REFERENCE

All 17 tools, 2 resources, and 2 slash prompts built into `flow-music-mcp` v1.1.0:

Tool / Capability Name	Phase / Type	What It Does
`check_status`	Setup (Tool)	Checks Gemini API key status, runtime config path, active project folder, and live `flowmusic.app` login/plan state on port 9334.
`set_gemini_key`	Setup (Tool)	Validates and saves your Google AI Studio API key (`AIzaSy...` or `AQ....`) to `~/.flow-music-mcp/gemini-key` immediately without restarting.
`login_flow_music`	Setup (Tool)	Launches the persistent Chrome window at `https://www.flowmusic.app/` on CDP port 9334 so you can sign in with Google.
`connect_project_folder`	Phase 1 (Tool)	Connects to your song folder, auto-detects the `.mp3`, probes duration, and creates `storyboard.json`, `STORYBOARD.md`, `characters/`, `scenes/`, and `videos/`.
`identify_lyrics_and_timestamps`	Phase 1 (Tool)	Uploads your MP3 to Gemini multimodal audio to extract timestamped lyrics (`MM:SS`), musical sections, BPM, key, and mood.
`set_style_and_characters`	Phase 2 (Tool)	Locks the Mandatory Style Anchor, lighting/color palette, and Character Model Sheets (appearance, props, outfits) for visual consistency.
`create_storyboard_scenes`	Phase 2 (Tool)	Saves the full list of sub-10-second storyboard scenes with `generate_start_frame` or `use_previous_last_frame` continuity modes.
`get_storyboard`	Phase 2–3 (Tool)	Returns the current storyboard state and syncs any manual changes made in `STORYBOARD.md`.
`edit_storyboard_scene`	Phase 3 (Tool)	Edits a single scene's timestamps, camera direction, action, `frame_mode`, character/outfit refs, or prompts.
`sync_storyboard_from_markdown`	Phase 3 (Tool)	Reads user edits made directly in the `STORYBOARD.md` table and updates `storyboard.json` + compiled prompts.
`generate_character_sheets`	Phase 4a (Tool)	Generates character reference sheets (`characters/*.png`) via Gemini 2026 image models (with automatic `flowmusic.app` browser fallback).
`generate_scene_start_frames`	Phase 4b (Tool)	Generates starting keyframe PNGs (`scenes/scene-NN-start.png`) for scenes using `generate_start_frame`, attaching character reference sheets.
`open_flow_music_session`	Phase 5a (Tool)	Opens a new session in `https://www.flowmusic.app/`, uploads the project MP3 via `Upload audio file`, and submits the overview prompt.
`generate_flow_music_videos`	Phase 5b (Tool)	Iterates through storyboard scenes in `flowmusic.app`, attaches start frames or extracted previous last frames, generates videos, and downloads MP4s to `videos/`.
`check_video_task`	Phase 5 (Tool)	Polls background task tickets when video generation runs longer than 45 seconds so Claude never times out.
`calculate_scene_frames`	Utility (Tool)	Calculates exact frame counts for a given duration and FPS, flagging any scene over 10 seconds.
`flow_music_browser_action`	Utility (Tool)	Inspects live DOM controls, takes screenshots, clicks buttons, fills inputs, or uploads files in the `flowmusic.app` Chrome window.
`storyboard://current/markdown`	MCP Resource	Read-only resource returning the active project's `STORYBOARD.md` file.
`config://studio/character-lock`	MCP Resource	Read-only resource returning the locked Mandatory Style Anchor and Character Model Sheets.
`music_video_workflow`	MCP Prompt	Step-by-step 5-phase production prompt template for any MP3 folder.
`review_scene_continuity`	MCP Prompt	Audits all scenes for sub-10s duration rules and `generate_start_frame` vs `use_previous_last_frame` continuity.